



An Roinn Dlí agus Cirt
Department of Justice

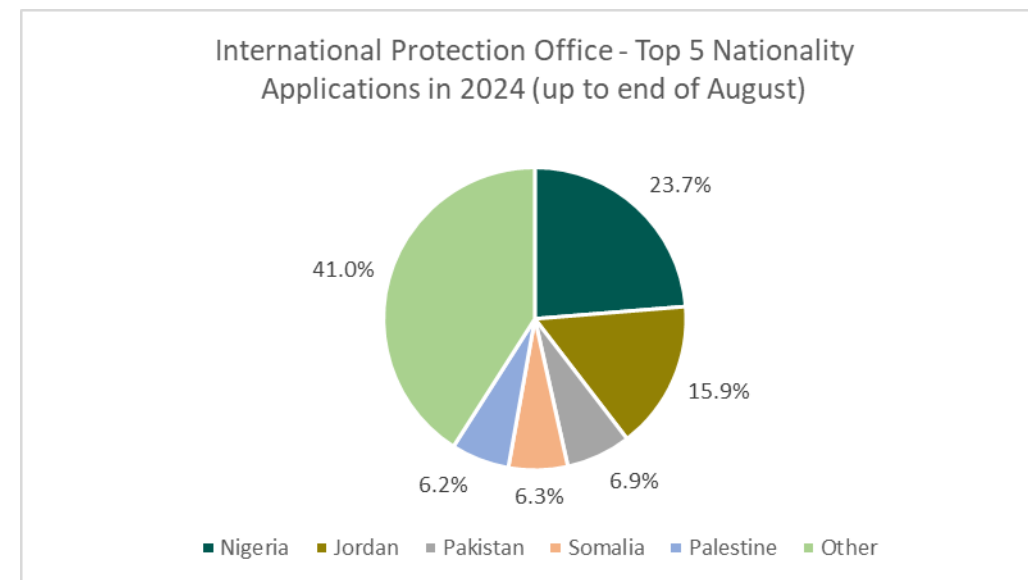
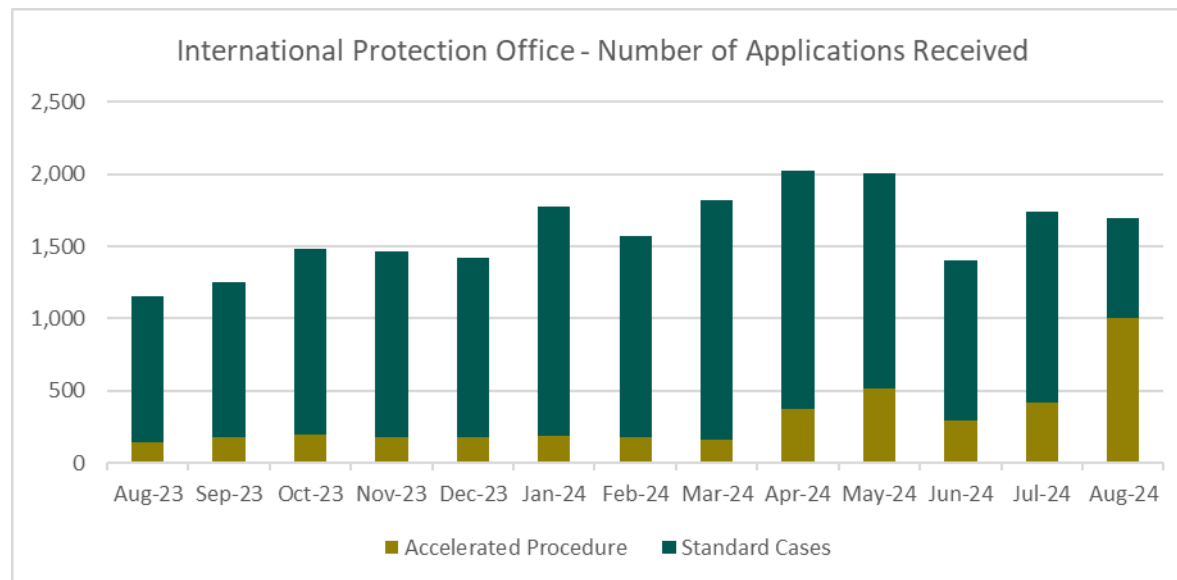
International Protection: August 2024

Executive Summary

The figures in this dashboard were extracted on the 05th September 2024. These are operational figures and subject to change. The charts below refer to key points in the asylum process. A flow chart is provided at the end of the pack that sets out this process. Overall, for August 2024:

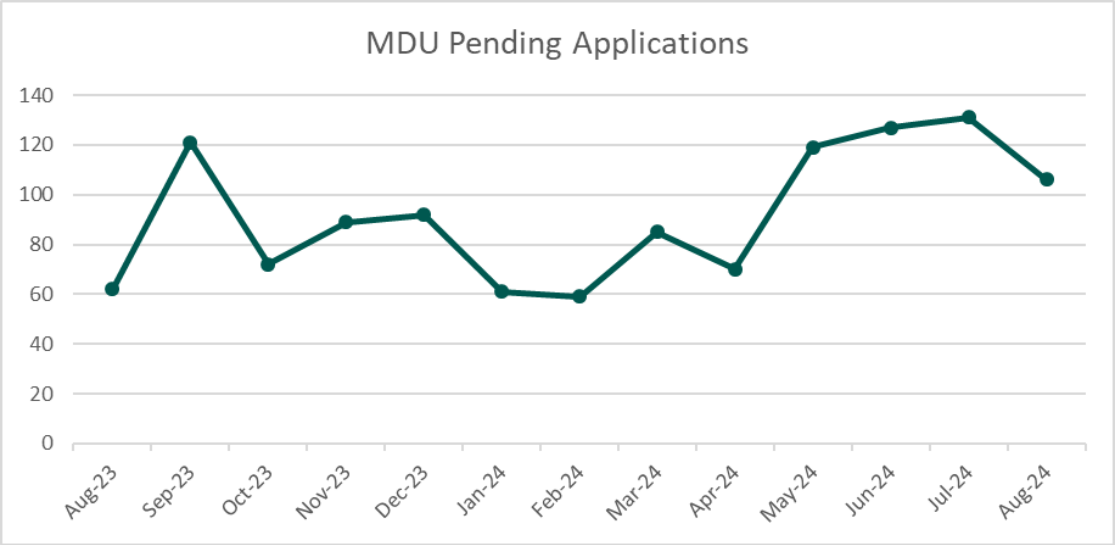
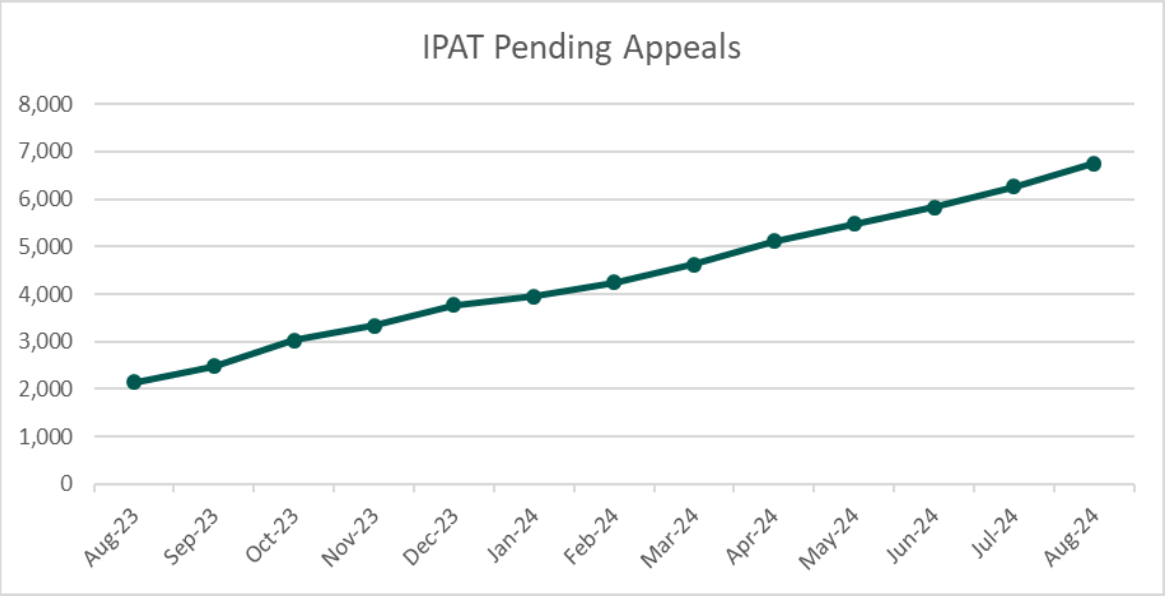
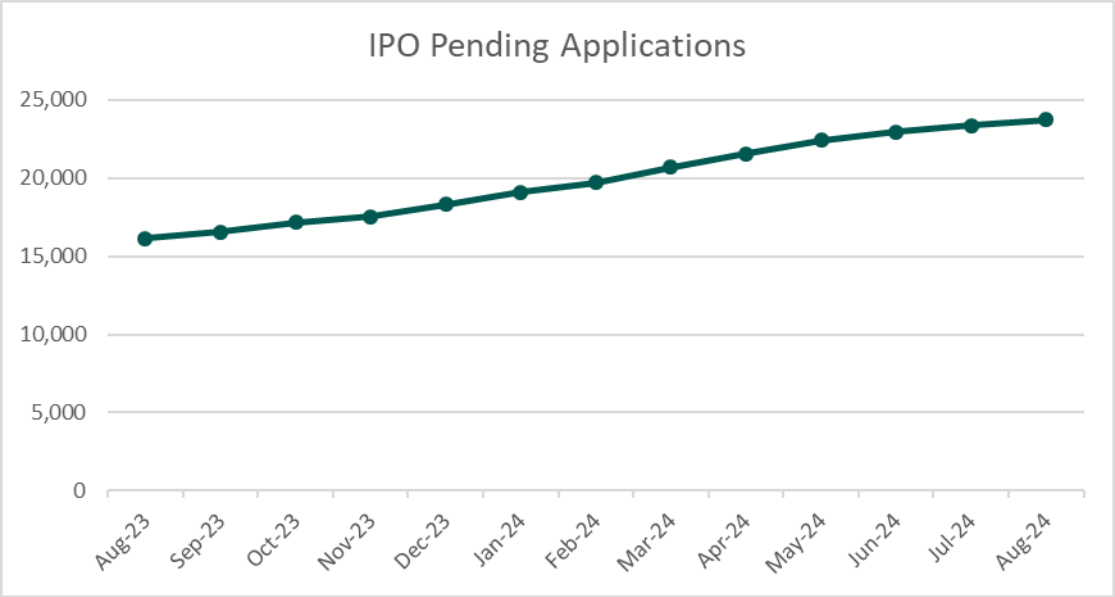
- The number of asylum applications continues to trend upwards. In August there were 1,692 applications received for asylum. This is up from 1,158 last August
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (3,324 applications), Jordan (2,225), Pakistan (971), Somalia (887) and Palestine (871)
- The number of applications pending in the IPO is slowly trending upwards. As of August this year there were 23,727 applications pending
- The number of applications in the IPO where a recommendation has been made or otherwise closed off has increased in August 2024 where 1,334 cases were closed off
- The median time to make a decision for standard cases has begun to trend slowly downwards, after having shown an upward trend between August 2023 and April 2024. In August 2024 the median processing time to determination was 75 weeks (compared to 82 weeks in May 2024 and 78.5 in January 2024)
- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing, up to 511 at the end of August 2024
- Of those applications where a decision was made in August by MDU, 32% of decisions were refusals, 4% permission to remain, and 64% were international protection grants
- August 2024 is the first time that the monthly number of Accelerated Procedure applications received is higher than the number of standard cases. There were 1,692 total applications, of which 669 (40%) were from Jordan and 182 (11%) were from Nigeria. There were 156 applications (9%) from all Safe Countries combined. The increase in Accelerated Procedure applications in August 2024 is therefore directly linked to the addition of Jordan to the accelerated provision

Applications and main nationalities



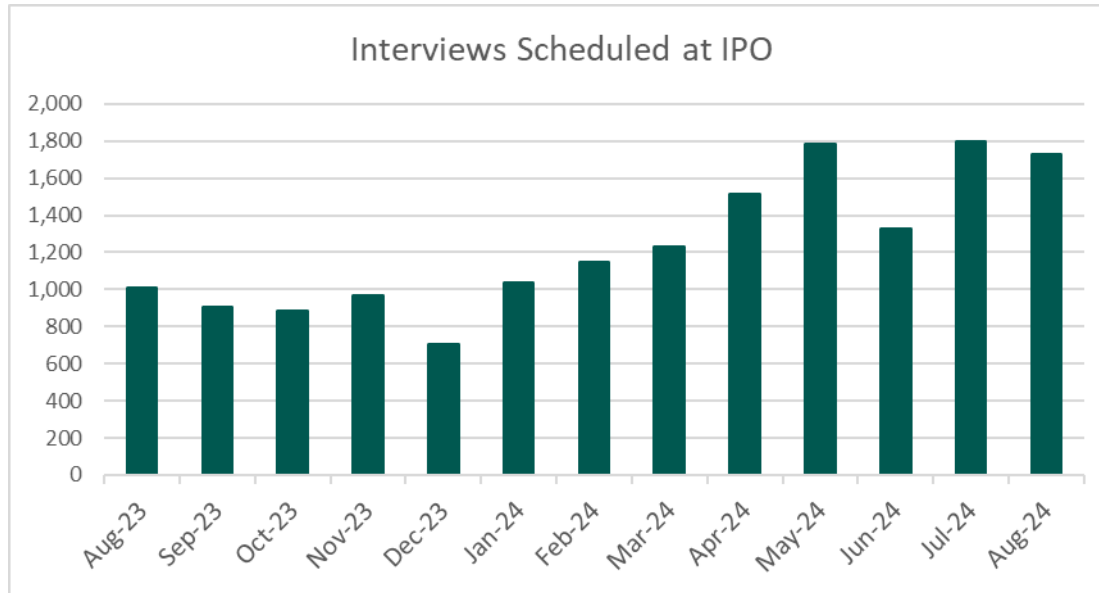
- In August there were 1,692 applications received for asylum. This is up from 1,158 last August. The average number of applications per month between September 2023 and August 2024 was 1,637
- For August 2024, the total number of applications included 1,007 from accelerated procedure (60% of all applicants)
- The main countries of origin for 2024 to date are: Nigeria (3,324 applications), Jordan (2,225), Pakistan (971), Somalia (887) and Palestine (871)

Pending International Protection Applications

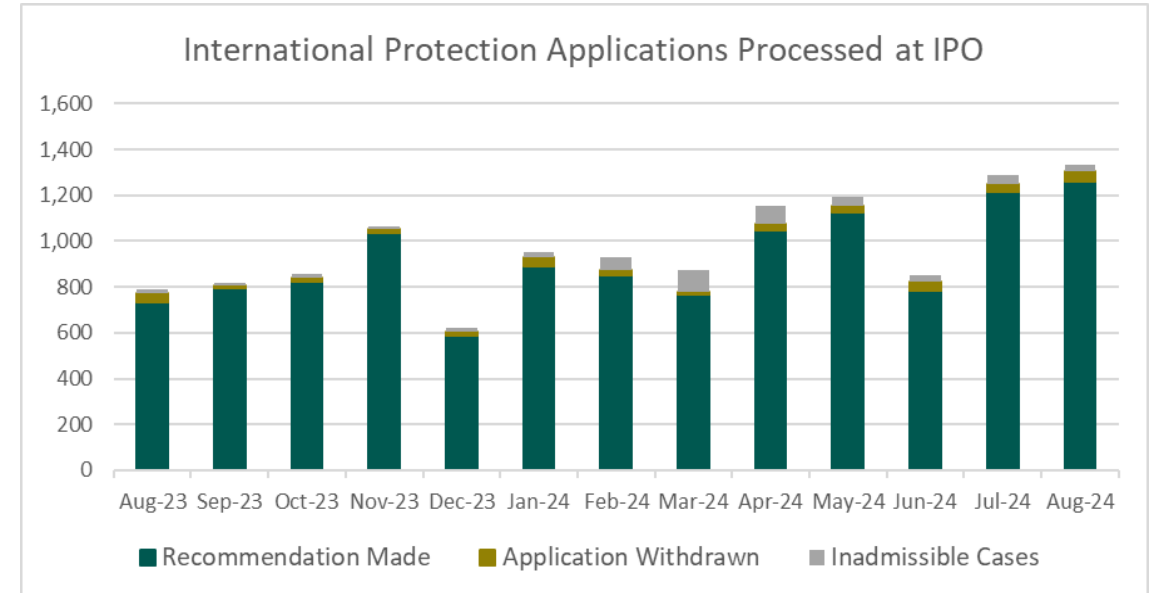


- The number of applications pending in the IPO is 23,727. The numbers have been gradually on the rise from September 2023 (16,566 cases pending)
- The number of pending applications for IPAT has been trending upwards since August 2023. In August 2024, there were 6,748 applications pending
- The pending figure for MDU at the end of August 2024 is 106

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

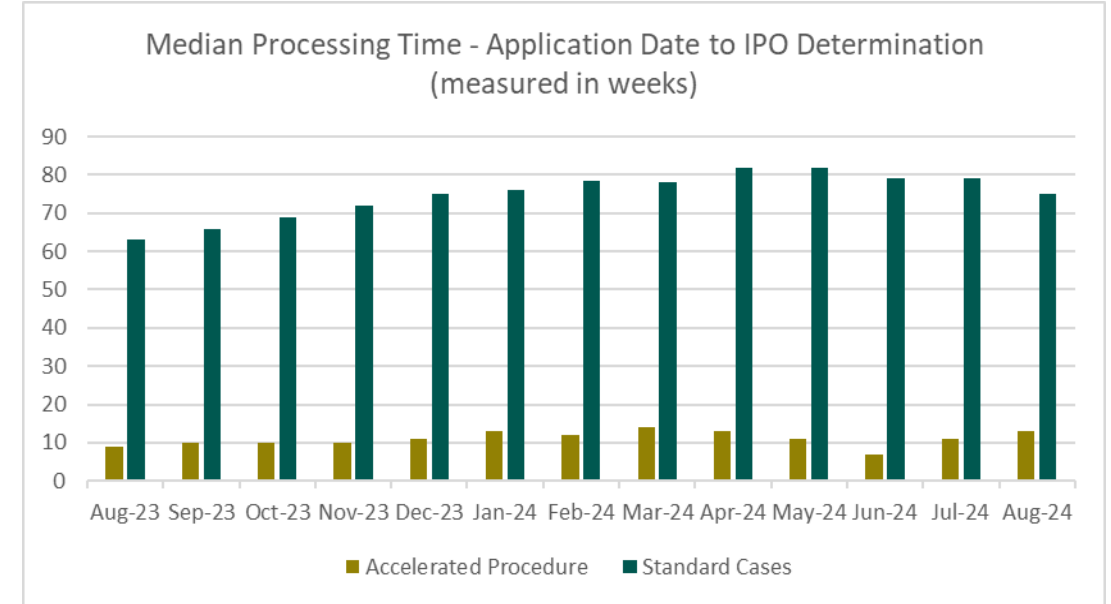
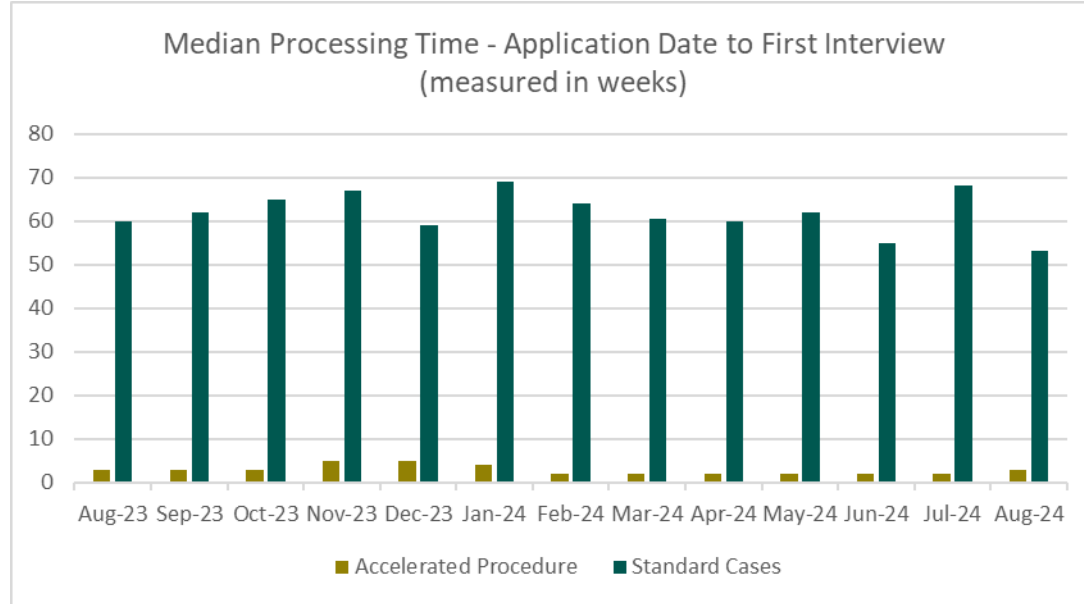


- The number of interviews scheduled at the IPO has been trending up in 2024, albeit with some fluctuations in recent months
- In August 2024, there were 1,732 interviews scheduled, down from 1,795 in July and up from 1,329 in June
- 2024 YTD interviews scheduled were 11,570 (an 84% increase on 6,286 interviews scheduled for 2023 YTD)



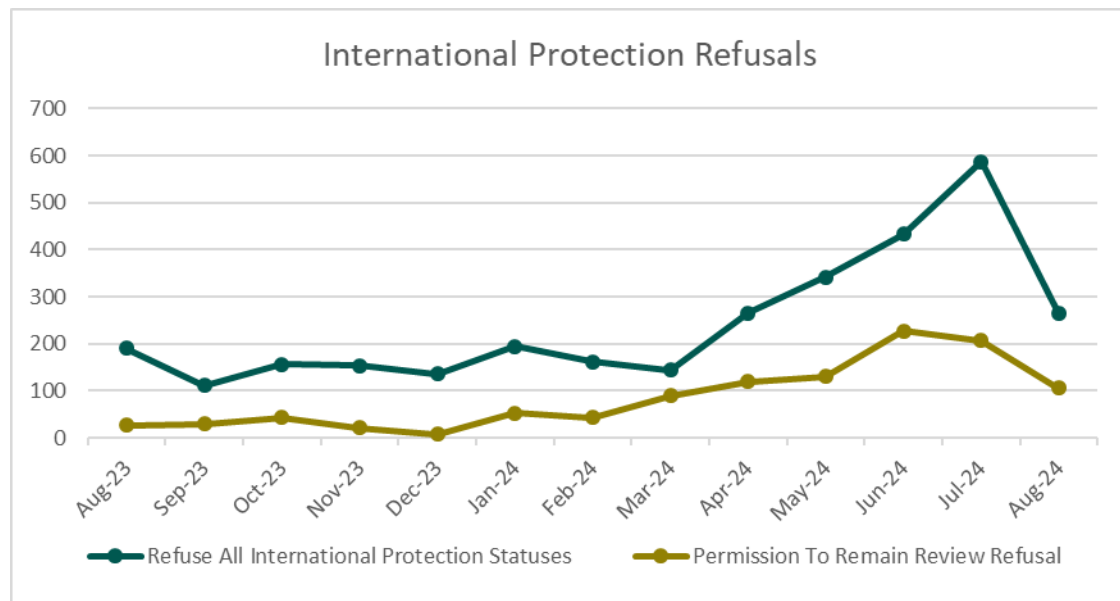
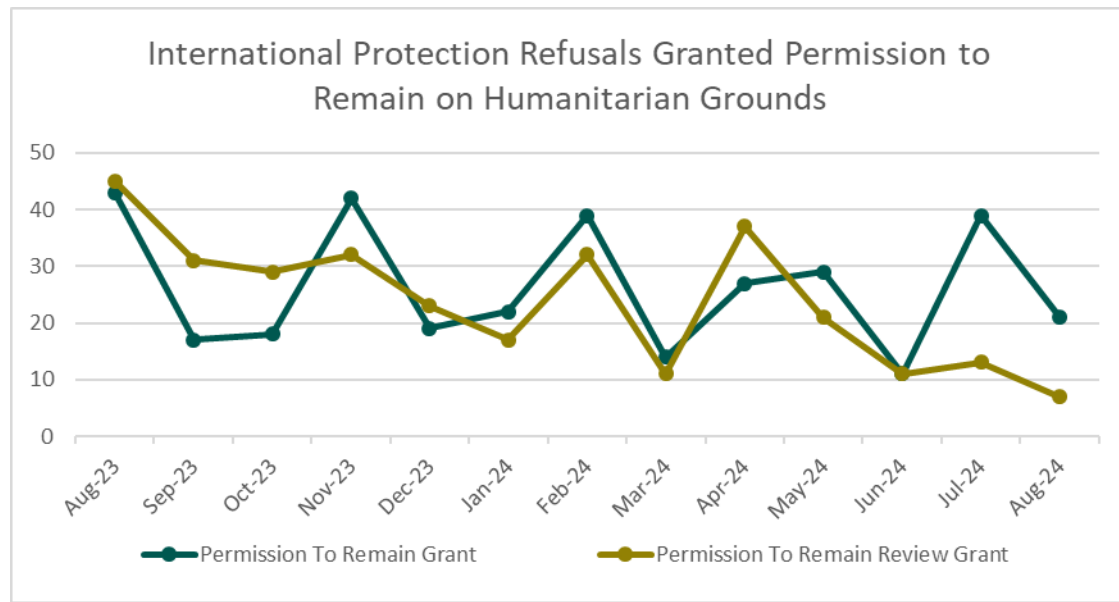
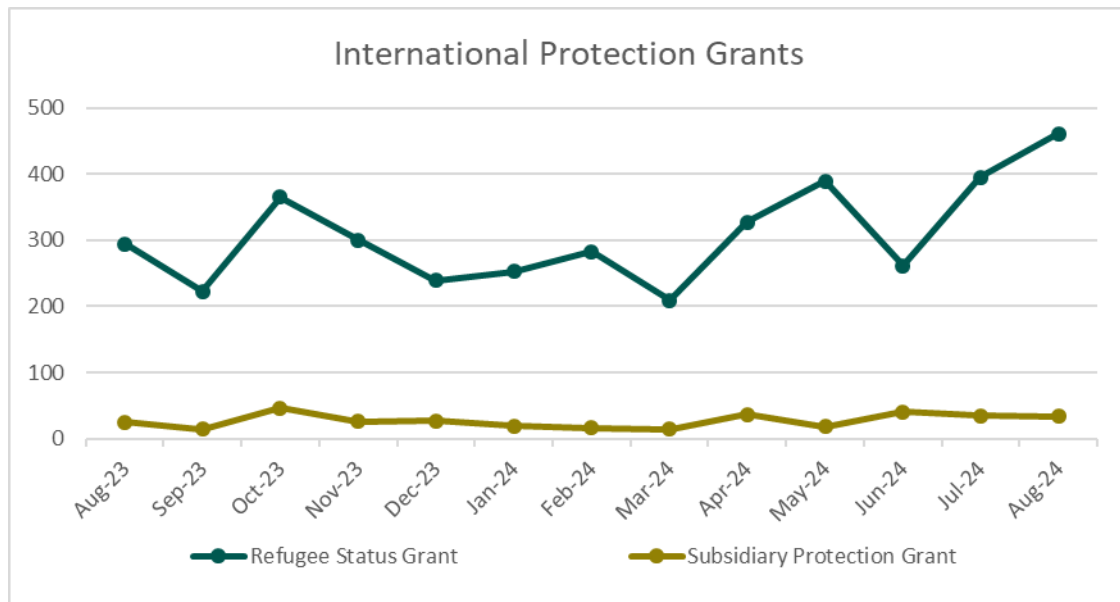
- This table is counting Recommendations Made, Applications Deemed Inadmissible and Applications Withdrawn
- In August 2024, 1,334 cases were closed off. This is up from 1,286 in July and 854 in June
- 2024 YTD applications processed were 8,577 (a 54.9% increase on 5,536 applications processed for 2023 YTD)

International Protection Applications Processing Times



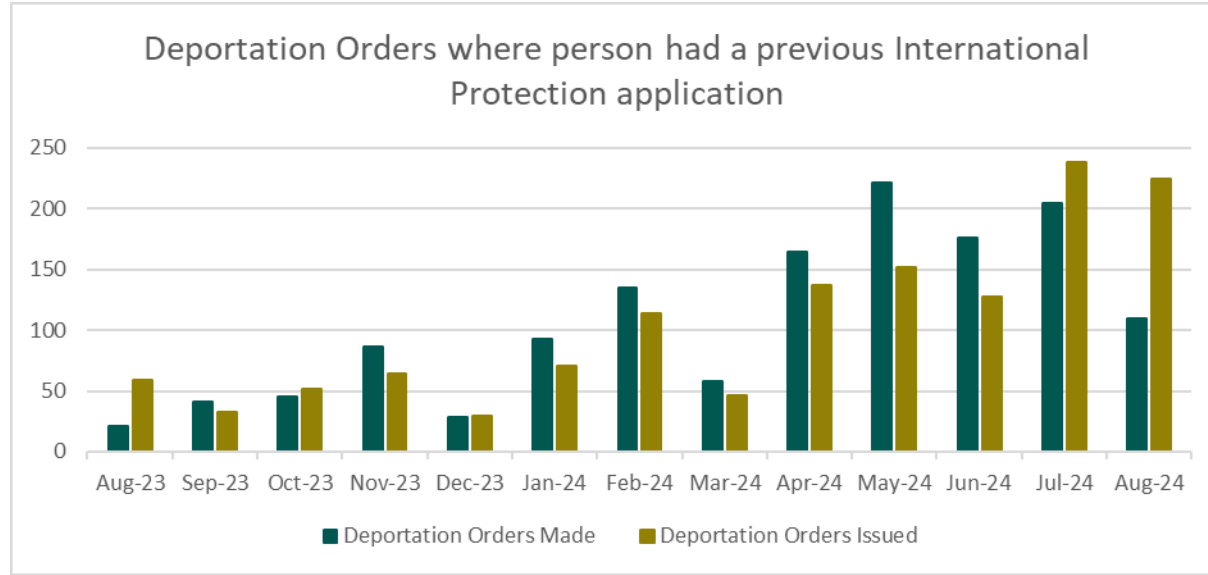
- Processing times are measured as a median. This represents the middle number in the range of times at hand for processing. The reason why the average is not used is that there are a handful of cases where processing times are long – this would disproportionately impact the average figure and not give a proper representation of processing time
- The median time to the first interview for all applications has fluctuated over the last few months. In August 2024, it was 53 weeks for standard cases, down from 68 weeks in July and 55 weeks in June
- For accelerated procedure only cases, the waiting time to the first interview for August was 3 weeks, up from 2 weeks in July and June
- The median processing time to determining an outcome to an asylum application had been slowly increasing since August 2023 but has shown a slight decrease since May 2024
- In August 2024, the median processing time to determination for standard cases was 75 weeks (down from 79 weeks in July and June and 82 weeks in May)
- For accelerated procedure only, the median processing time was 13 weeks in August, up from 11 weeks in July and 7 weeks in June

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

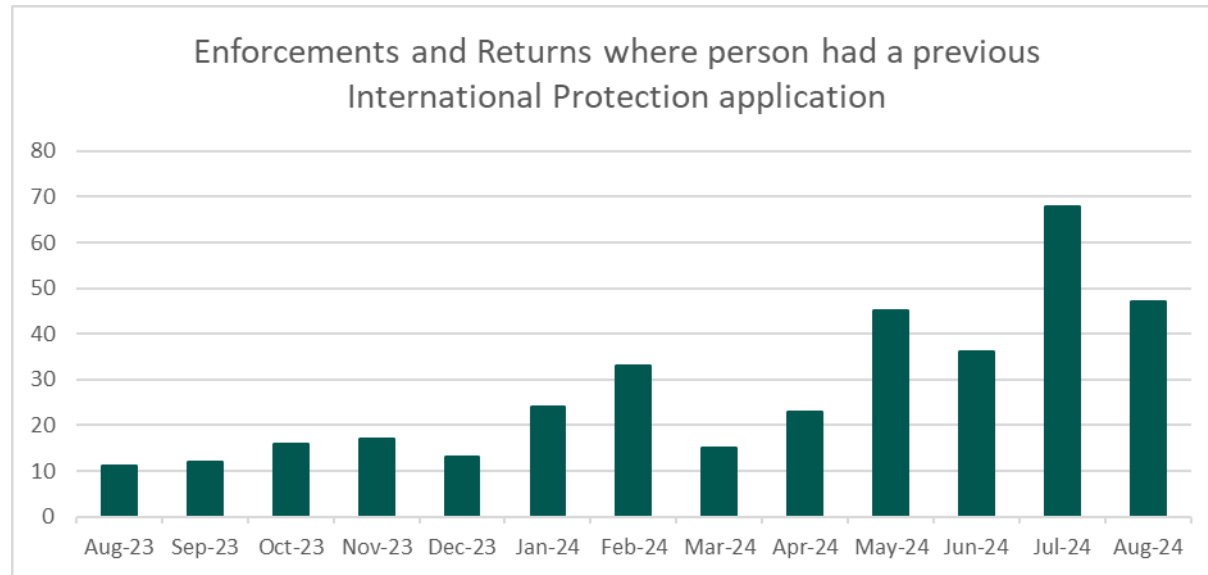


- In August, of those applications where a decision was made, 461 were given refugee status grant and 34 subsidiary protection grant (495 in total). There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- Of those who were refused refugee status and subsidiary protection, 21 were given Permission to Remain on humanitarian grounds with 7 on a Permission to Remain Review Grant. There is significant variation in these decisions over the last few months with no clear trend
- There were 266 refusals for International Protection Statuses and 106 for Permission to Remain Review
- Overall for August, 32% of decisions were refusals, 4% permission to remain, and 64% were international protection grants

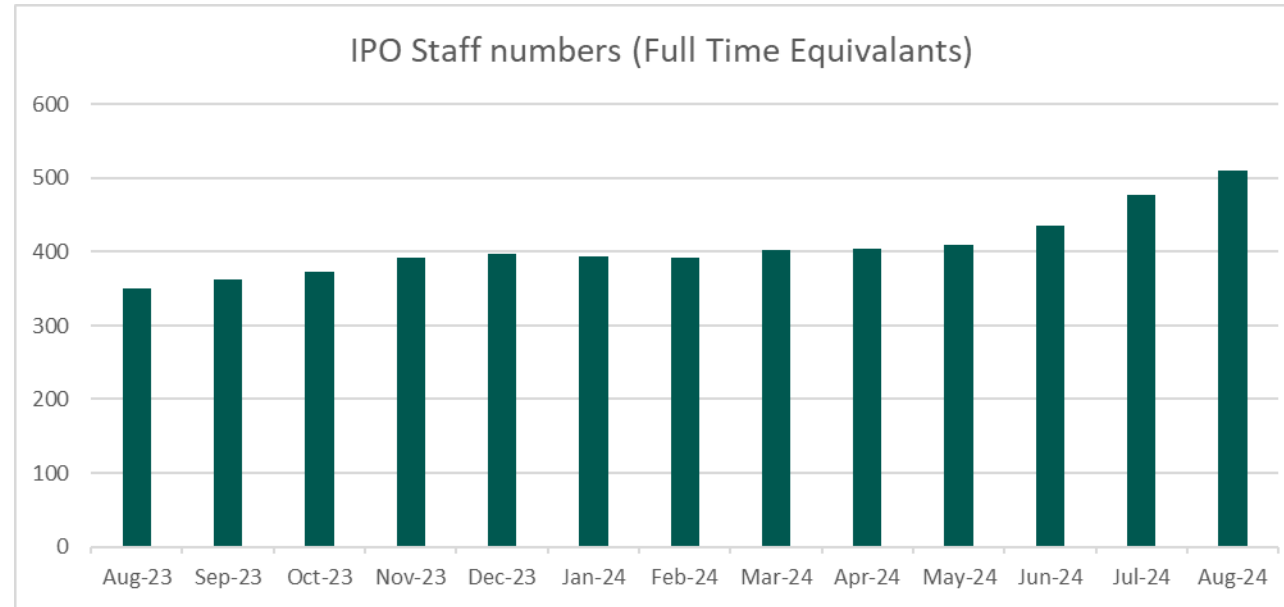
Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals



- For August 2024 the number of deportation orders signed (where a person had a previous asylum application) was 110 and the number of deportation orders issued was 225. For July, the figures were 205 and 238 and for June it was 176 and 130, respectively
- For August 2024 the number of removals was 47



IPO Staff number (Full-Time Equivalents)



- The number of staff in the IPO has gradually been increasing.
- In August 2023 there were 351 FTEs in IPO. This number has been slowly trending upwards, to 392 in February 2024 and 410 in May 2024.
- At the end of August 2024, the IPO had 511 FTE staff.



Appendix

Methodology

Pending International Protection Applications

- IPO – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- IPAT – Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- MDU – Data sourced from AISIP. Pending figure does not include legacy cases – the legacy data has been captured in such a way that it cannot be accurately reported on

International Protection: Interviews and Applications Processed

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes

International Protection Applications Processing Times

- Data sourced from Lotus Notes
- Applicants to whom section 38(5) of the International Protection Act 2015 applies (failure to co-operate) are included in the calculations
- Where an interview took place after a case was reactivated the reactivation date is used as the application date, otherwise the original application date was used for the processing time calculation
- The median calculation is used for processing time at IPO as there are significant outliers in the length of time asylum applications can spend in processing. This is typically due to lengthy procedures such as judicial reviews which are complex and time consuming by their nature, and which are also outside of the remit and control of the IPO during that part of the process. The median is a more accurate measure of the time spent by the IPO in processing applications.

Methodology

International Protection Decisions – Granted and Refused

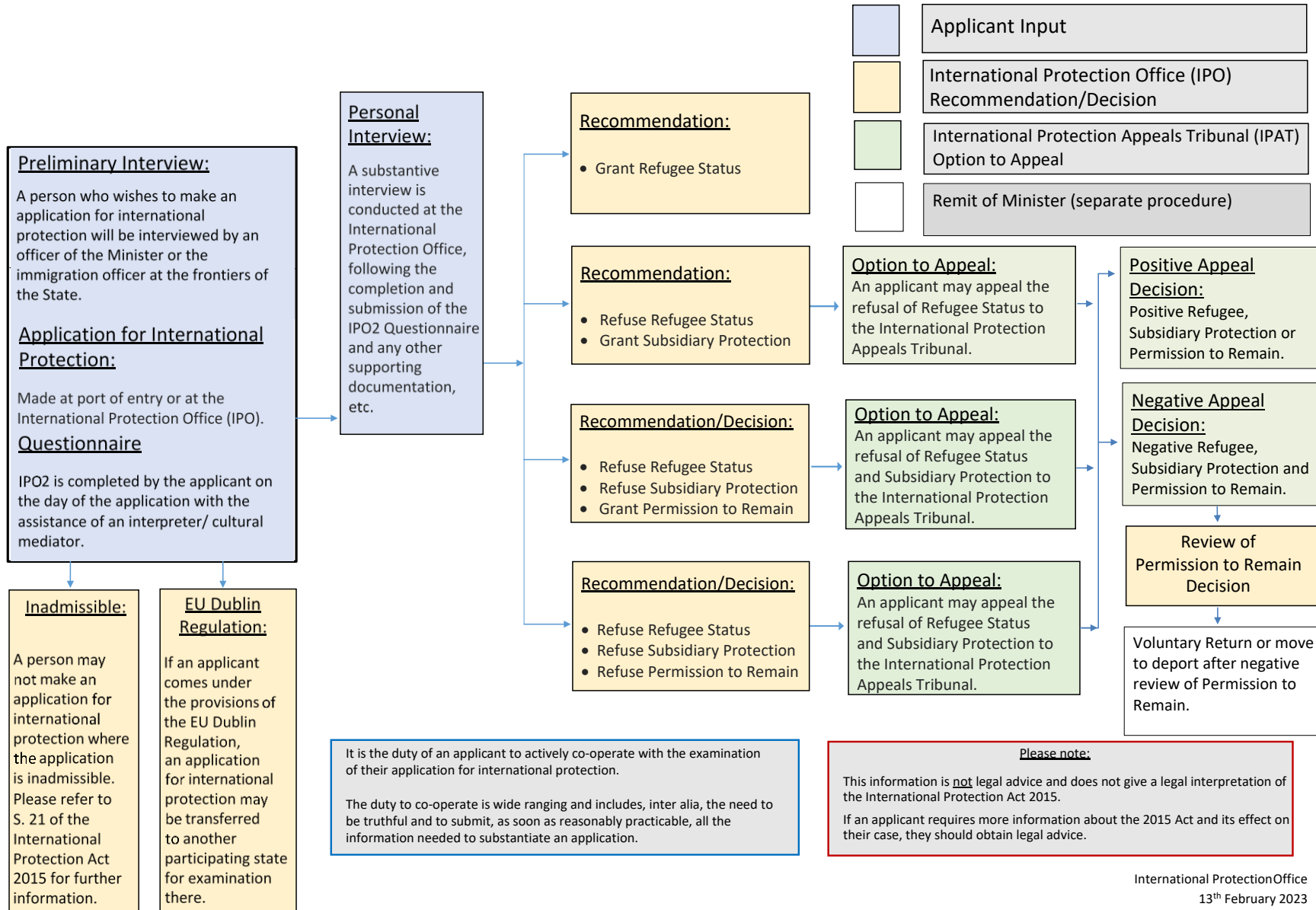
- Quashed decisions and Revocation of Status are not included
- Decision figures include international protection decisions (IPDN) and legacy application types
- Each applicant is represented once in the granted and refused tables
 - For example, if a person is refused refugee status but is granted subsidiary protection they are recorded once in the tables as a subsidiary protection grant. This is to more clearly represent the overall numbers of granted and refused applicants, and to avoid double counting of individuals where they are refused one type of status but are granted another.
- Some of the applicants who have been granted permission to remain are also included in the 'Refuse All International Protection Statuses' category of the refusals table. Permission to remain is a humanitarian permission. In order to be considered for permission to remain you must first have been refused international protection. On slide 7, the 'International Protection Refusals Granted Permission to Remain on Humanitarian Grounds' chart is a combination of applicants still in the asylum process and applicants who have finished the process. The 'International Protection Refusals' chart includes only those applicants who have finished the asylum process.
- Where a revocation occurs the original grant is removed from the figures for the month the permission was originally granted. For example, if an application was granted in January but subsequently revoked later in the year the January figure is updated to remove the grant

Deportation Orders and Enforcement/Removals

- Data for the International Protection Deportation Order (IPDP) application type is sourced from AISIP. All other data is sourced from Lotus Notes

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015

General Overview of Process under International Protection Act 2015



Data Tables (1)

International Protection Office - Applications Received

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
Accelerated Procedure	145	180	193	175	182	186	183	162	374	519	292	416	1007
Standard Cases	1013	1068	1287	1287	1241	1588	1384	1659	1651	1491	1112	1320	685

International Protection Office – Top 5 Nationality Applications

Top 5 nationalities 2024 to date	Applications	% Total
Nigeria	3324	23.7%
Jordan	2225	15.9%
Pakistan	971	6.9%
Somalia	887	6.3%
Palestine	871	6.2%
Other	5744	41.0%
Total	14022	

Data Tables (2)

International Protection Office - Pending Applications

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
IP Pending	16,165	16,566	17,171	17,524	18,314	19,109	19,719	20,695	21,577	22,419	22,965	23,360	23,727

International Protection Appeals Tribunal - Pending Applications

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
IPAT Pending	2150	2478	3020	3337	3762	3949	4251	4620	5110	5478	5821	6257	6748

Ministerial Decisions Unit - Pending Applications

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
MDU Pending	62	121	72	89	92	61	59	85	70	119	127	131	106

Data Tables (3)

International Protection Office – Interview Scheduled

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
Interviews Scheduled	1012	904	887	966	705	1037	1148	1233	1511	1785	1329	1795	1732

International Protection Office – Processed Cases

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
Recommendation Made	732	795	825	1039	588	892	850	766	1047	1127	786	1213	1258
Application Withdrawn	39	9	16	14	19	37	25	10	28	25	37	36	45
Inadmissible Cases	17	14	16	14	16	24	57	98	77	40	31	37	31

Data Tables (4)

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to First Interview (measured in weeks)

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
Accelerated Procedure	3	3	3	5	5	4	2	2	2	2	2	2	3
Standard Cases	60	62	65	67	59	69	64	60.5	60	62	55	68	53

International Protection Office Median Process Time – Application Date to IPO Determination (measured in weeks)

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
Accelerated Procedure	9	10	10	10	11	13	12	14	13	11	7	11	13
Standard Cases	63	66	69	72	75	76	78.5	78	82	82	79	79	75

Data Tables (5)

International Protection Decisions – Grants

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
Refugee Status Grant	294	223	365	300	239	253	283	209	327	389	261	395	461
Subsidiary Protection Grant	25	14	46	26	27	19	16	14	36	18	40	35	34
Permission To Remain Grant	43	17	18	42	19	22	39	14	27	29	11	39	21
Permission To Remain Review Grant	45	31	29	32	23	17	32	11	37	21	11	13	7

International Protection Decisions – Refusals

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
Refuse All International Protection Statuses	190	111	156	154	136	195	162	144	265	342	433	587	266
Permission To Remain Review Refusal	27	30	43	22	8	53	43	90	119	130	227	207	106

Data Tables (6)

Deportation Orders where person had a previous International Protection application

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
Deportation Orders Made	21	41	45	86	28	93	135	58	164	221	176	205	110
Deportation Orders Issued	59	33	52	64	29	71	114	46	137	152	128	238	225

Deportation Enforcements and Returns where person had a previous International Protection application

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
Enforcements/Returns	11	12	16	17	13	24	33	15	23	45	36	68	47

Data Tables (7)

International Protection Office Staff Numbers (Full-Time Equivalents)

	Aug-23	Sep-23	Oct-23	Nov-23	Dec-23	Jan-24	Feb-24	Mar-24	Apr-24	May-24	Jun-24	Jul-24	Aug-24
IPO Staffing Level	350.5	361.9	373.1	392.1	398.1	394.1	392.1	402.85	404.85	409.7	435.7	477.7	510.7